

KAREN CONTI

IN SHORT: You're a vestimancer, casting spells by and through garments. You've done some movie costuming, but right now you're in an occult burglary crew.

THE WORST THING THAT EVER HAPPENED

TO YOU: You'd just gotten your brakes fixed. Like *three days* before. You put on the brakes going downhill and nothing happened, just nothing at all, and you froze in shock, pumping the pedal stupidly, thinking maybe you'd gotten the gas by mistake?

The brakes had been funny and money had been tight, but you figured the part that makes the car stop is nothing to play around with. It should have all been OK and that disconnect, that *not making sense*, it stunned you for just a second. Maybe two. If you'd been in a racecar driver's uniform, you could have ditched out easy, or remembered to use the parking brake, but all you did was honk once, then lay on the horn, and she looked up at you stupidly right before you plowed into her and her stroller.

She looked really tired. You remember being that tired when your daughter was that age, too young to walk on her own.

The mom lived.

The mom also sued you for about two weeks of sleepless nights before the lawyer you couldn't really afford proved that you'd had the brakes repaired three days earlier. Eventually they found a manufacturing defect in your replacement brake cable and you wound up suing the factory alongside the mom. Her name's Loretta Banks and you absolutely do not keep in touch.

The lawyer was an unexpected expense and money stayed scarce while the brake-cable company resisted, so there was no question of seeing a counselor or anything. The best you were able to do was some trade in-kind with a psychic who suggested you leave your husband Leo. When you brought this up to him, the argument was extremely ugly and it kind of forced your hand. You divorced, moved away, and he hid your child from you until he was convicted of housebreaking. So now Cloisonné lives with you and, to be honest, she drives you everywhere. You can't stand to get behind the wheel. You just can't stand it.

YOUR INTRODUCTION TO THE OCCULT:

It was a warped family tradition. Your mom was... not great at mom stuff, with the exception of Halloween costumes, which she was embarrassingly *good* at. She taught you to never, ever, *ever* be naked and, when you were old enough, how to make an invisibility cloak and sew wings that let you turn into a swan. But you hate doing the swan business, because you're naked when you change back and you don't like being naked ever. (You have a sort of process of half-show-ering with a cap and a two-piece bathing suit.)

If it wasn't for lingerie, you never could have conceived Cloisonné.

WHY ARE YOU WILLING TO DRIVE TO CANADA AND ROB A MUSEUM?:

You took part in a ceremony a few years back with this herbalist named Guadalupe and some friends of hers, in which you all took on ceremonial roles and invoked assorted magick traditions to perceive a deeper wisdom and, in addition to finding out that it was your great-grandmother who first started vestimancy in your family, you had a vision of a big stone boulder head. It came associated with a terrible sense of pain and age and risk. When Doctor A showed you the newspaper clipping of the head from Ohio, it was the same one.

A COUPLE OTHER THINGS YOU SHOULD

KNOW: The year is 2017 and you don't speak French.

THE REST OF THE CREW

- **Dr. Angel Culbard:** Half the time, an absolutely sensible scientist. Half the time, operates like a drug-trance oracle, only with other people's trances.
- **Cloisonné Farr:** Your brilliant daughter. You rely on her too much, you know this, but you can't seem to stop yourself.
- **Jesse Viscarrat:** You're a little wary of Jesse, who reminds you of too many paranormal bottom feeders. Jesse has practical ritual experience, but no framework for how it all works, what it all *means*. You sometimes hope to fix that.
- **Lee Ybarra:** A former Marine is intimidating enough without also being a computer hacker. Lee's in charge of two spheres that frighten and confuse you. You feel bad about their injured legs though.

YOUR SPECIAL OUTFITS

Make sure you're up to speed on **vestimancy**. You start out with 25 significant charges and you aren't getting any more. You've been hoarding a little since Cloisonné came back into your life.

- Full police officer's uniform
- Competition judo gi with black belt
- Surgical gear, complete with mask, gloves, cap, and booties
- Firefighter's turnout gear with air tank
- Vintage USSR Army officer's cap
- Gyges' cloak (please describe)
- Swan maiden wings
- Some of your husband's old clothing

Note that you don't have the clothes required to turn into a wolf or harm people. That's not how you want to use your Art.

Vestimancy - Book One: Play, pages 166-169

Name: Karen Conti
Cabal: Headhunters
Current Objective: Steal a 600-pound stone head from a museum in Quebec.

Distinguishing Characteristics:

RAGE Intolerance

NOBLE Honest communication

FEAR Personal nakedness

Cloisonné

50% Favorite
(Status)

Doctor A

40% Guru
(Notice)

Lee

60% Mentor
(Connect)

The Cabal

45% Responsibility
(Knowledge)

Jesse

55% Protégé
(Fitness)

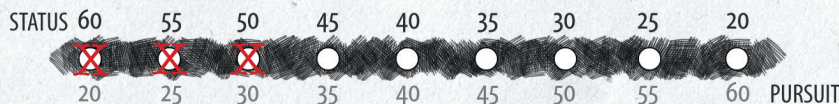
HELPLESSNESS



FAILURES

Defend with Status
Attack with Connect

ISOLATION



Defend with Connect
Attack with Status

SELF



Defend with Notice
Attack with Knowledge

UNNATURAL



Defend with Knowledge
Attack with Secrecy

VIOLENCE



Defend with Fitness
Attack with Struggle

IDENTITIES

I'm a clothing designer/seamstress, of course I can darn a sock, make you look good, have needles & fabric on hand
Failed! ☐ **54** %

Substitutes for Ability: Pursuit

Feature: Substitutes for Lie

Feature: Substitutes for Secrecy

I'm a, of course I can
Failed! ☐ %

Substitutes for Ability:

Feature:

Feature:

I'm a, of course I can
Failed! ☐ %

Substitutes for Ability:

Feature:

Feature:

I'm a, of course I can
Failed! ☐ %

Substitutes for Ability:

Feature:

Feature:

**WOUND
THRESHOLD**

50

56070

1a. Adept School
VESTIMANCER

1b. Percentage
66

For Official Use
Only GR3-GST-0Z

4a. Spell Name:

4b. Cost:

2. Taboos

Be seen naked.
(Book 1, p. 166)

4c. Effect

...all them spells on pages 166-169 (Book One).

5a. Spell Name:

5b. Cost:

5c. Effect

3. Domain

Social roles,
garment functions,
appearance, shape,
identity

6a. Spell Name:

6b. Cost:

6c. Effect

7a. Minor Charges

Create a new garment

7b. Significant Charges

Create an entirely new outfit OR acquire a legacy garment

7c. Major Charges

Design a new type of garment that gets wide recognition